SLICER TEMPLATE, TYPES OF SLICERS, EDIT INTERACTION, TABLE & MATRIX VISUALS IN POWER BI

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1. Introduction to Slicer in Power BI

A **Slicer** is one of the most powerful interactive elements in Power BI. As the name suggests, a slicer is used to **slice the data**—meaning, filter the entire dataset or selected visuals based on specific criteria. Slicers enhance user interactivity by letting report viewers choose the exact portion of the data they want to analyze.

A slicer helps answer questions like:

- What are the sales in a particular month?
- How does performance differ across categories?
- Which products performed well within a selected region?

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Instead of adjusting page filters repeatedly, slicers allow users to simply click options on the report page.

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2. Purpose of Slicer Template

When designing dashboards, a slicer:

- Makes reports **dynamic and interactive**.
- Allows users to focus on relevant portions of the data.
- Builds cleaner dashboards without overcrowding visuals.
- Enables segmentation of metrics based on user-selected fields such as **month, category, date, region, or custom ranges**.



Slicers can be used to filter:

- **Categorical values** (e.g., months, categories, states)
- **Numerical ranges** (e.g., sales amount range)
- **Dates** (e.g., year, quarter, month, day)
- **Parameters** (such as custom values or thresholds)

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3. Adding a Slicer to the Canvas

To add a slicer:

1. Click on the **Slicer template** icon in the Visualizations pane.
2. A blank slicer appears on the report canvas.
3. Drag a field (e.g., Month) into the slicer's **Field** area.
4. Power BI automatically generates slicer options for the chosen field.

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For example:

- Dragging *Month* shows all months.
- Clicking *May* filters all visuals on the page to show only May data.

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4. Slicing by Month – Example

Once the slicer is added and Month is selected:

- All months appear as selectable buttons/labels.
- Clicking a month (e.g., May) filters:
    - KPIs
    - Cards
    - Charts
    - Gauges
    - Tables
    - Other visuals on the page

Thus, the slicer becomes the controlling element for the report.

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5. Changing Slicer Settings – Select All Option

By default, slicers do NOT show a **Select All** option.

To enable it:

1. Go to **Format → Slicer Settings**.
2. Turn ON **Select All**.

Now users can:

- Select everything at once.
- Deselect all in one click.
- Use "Select All" as a toggle to reset filters.

This is useful when:

- You want to compare one month vs. all months.
- You temporarily reduce the dataset to a single segment, then expand it back.

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6. Single Select vs Multi-select

Slicers offer two important behaviors:

➢ Single Select ON

- Only **one item** can be selected at a time.
- Useful for KPIs where values must reflect a single time period.

➢ Single Select OFF

- Users can select **multiple values**.
- "Select All" becomes available.

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These settings define how the slicer behaves, depending on whether your analysis requires exclusive or inclusive filtering.

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7. Edit Interactions – Controlling Which Visuals Respond to a Slicer

A major feature of Power BI is **Edit Interactions**, which lets you control how slicers affect each visual on the page.

Why It Is Needed

There are cases where:

- Not all visuals should filter based on the slicer.
- Example: A Gauge visual showing total annual performance should remain constant even when monthly slicers change.

Steps to Use Edit Interaction

1. Select the **Slicer visualization**.
2. Go to the **Format tab**.
3. Click **Edit Interactions**.
4. Icons appear on every visual:
    - **Filter icon (Funnel)** → Slicer filters this visual.
    - **No filter icon (Circle with bar)** → Slicer does NOT affect this visual.

Example Scenario

- Requirement: Only KPI Cards should change when selecting months.
- Gauge visual should remain unchanged.

Steps:

- Click slicer → Format → Edit Interactions.
- On the Gauge visual → Click the "Stop Filtering" icon.

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Now:

- KPI cards change when months change.
- Gauge visual remains static.

You can toggle between:

- Filter
- No Filter

This provides high customization in your dashboard behavior.

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8. Different Types of Slicers in Power BI

Power BI provides **four kinds of slicers**, each suited to specific use-cases.

8.1 Regular Slicer

This is the default slicer.

Features:

- Displays values as a list.
- Supports checkboxes.
- Allows Single or Multiple selections.
- Can enable "Select All."

Use it for simple dropdown-type filtering.

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8.2 Button Slicer (New Generation Slicer)

A more modern and visually appealing slicer type.

Features

- Values appear as **buttons**.
- Highly customizable:
    - Background color
    - Button shape
    - Button spacing
    - Border
    - Hover effects
- “Select All” is available.

Use Case

Excellent for:

- Time period selections (Month, Quarter, Year)
- Category-based filtering
- Improving UI/UX

Example:
Button slicer showing:

| Jan | Feb | Mar | Apr | … |

Each month is a clickable button.

8.3 Text Slicer

A practical slicer for typing instead of selecting.

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How It Works

- You type the value you want to filter.
- For example, typing “A” filters Category A.
- Hit Enter → slicer applies filter.
- Multiple values can be added (A, C, D).

Use Case

Useful when:

- The list of values is long.
- Users already know what they want to filter.
- Category names are specific or coded.

Example:
Field: Category
User types:
A → filters only A
B → filters only B

You can even stack multiple values like:
A
C
D

8.4 List Slicer

This is a simplified version of the regular slicer where items are shown in a clear vertical list.

Features:

- Values appear in list format.
- Suitable for small sets of categories.

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Example:
Category
A
B
C
D
E

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9. General Formatting Options for All Slicers

Power BI slicers support a wide range of formatting:

- **Title formatting**
- **Background color**
- **Borders**
- **Padding**
- **Effects**
- **Data formatting**
- **Search bar inside slicer**
- **Item font size**
- **Text wrap**
- **Orientation (horizontal/vertical)**

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10. Table Visual in Power BI

After slicers, the next visual discussed is the **Table visual**.

A table is similar to an Excel table:

- It displays raw data in rows and columns.
- Allows sorting, filtering, and conditional formatting.

10.1 Adding Columns to a Table

To build a table:

1. Insert **Table** visual.
2. Add fields like:
    - Order ID
    - Category
    - Subcategory
    - Date
    - Profit
    - Sales

Each field becomes a column.

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10.2 Increasing Font Size

You can modify:

- Column headers (e.g., increase to size 20)
- Column values (size 20 or any preferred size)

This improves readability.

10.3 Date Hierarchies

Dates often appear as:

- Year
- Quarter
- Month

- Day

If you need exact dates:

- Go to the field dropdown.
- Change from **Date Hierarchy** to **Date**.

This displays actual order dates.

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11. Matrix Visual in Power BI

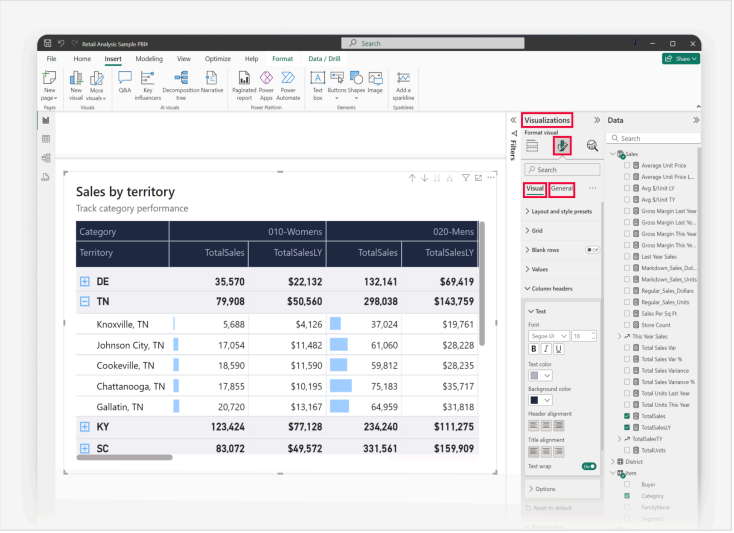
A **Matrix** is similar to an Excel Pivot Table.

Why Matrix Is Useful

Unlike a table, a matrix:

- Groups and aggregates data.
- Shows hierarchies.
- Allows drill-up and drill-down.
- Offers row and column summarization.

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Example

If Category and Subcategory are added:

- Category becomes a parent.
- Subcategories appear beneath it.
- Values show aggregated totals per group.

Matrix automatically:

- Arranged hierarchy.
- Creates grouped views.
- Summarizes data.

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12. Switching Between Table and Matrix

Power BI lets you toggle from:

- **Table → Matrix**
- **Matrix → Table**

Using a simple button.

This transforms the same data into:

- A raw data view (Table)
- A summarized grouping view (Matrix)

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13. Conditional Formatting in Table and Matrix

Both visuals support powerful formatting options:

Types of Conditional Formatting

1. **Background color** based on value.
2. **Font color** based on value.
3. **Data bars**.
4. **Icons** based on rules.
5. **Color scales** showing low-to-high values.

Example

Profit column:

- High profits → Green background.
- Losses → Red background.

Icons can also be used:

- Up arrow for growth.
- Down arrow for decline.

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14. Column Level Formatting

Power BI provides unique control:

- You can apply formatting to **specific columns only**.
- Adjust:
    - Alignment,
    - Background color,
    - Font color,
    - Icon sets,
    - Width,
    - Totals on/off.

This is extremely helpful for highlighting important metrics such as:

- Profit
- Sales
- Quantity
- Discount

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15. Using Matrix for Summaries

Matrix is the best visual for:

- Showing summarized data.
- Grouping by multiple categories.
- Comparing results across segments.

Example:

Category → Subcategory → Profit
Matrix automatically creates a nested structure:

Category A
    Subcategory X – Profit
    Subcategory Y – Profit

Category B
    Subcategory X – Profit
    Subcategory Z – Profit

Total Profit → displayed at bottom.

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16. Benefits of Slicers, Table, and Matrix Together

When combined:

- **Slicers** control the data shown.
- **Tables** display item-level details.
- **Matrix** shows summarized insights.

This combination gives the user:

- High interactivity
- Easy comparison
- Effective drilldown

- Better exploration of data segments

17.Summary

The content covered demonstrates how Power BI’s slicers and tabular visuals create a powerful, interactive environment for analysis.

Key Takeaways

- Slicers allow dynamic data filtering.
- Edit Interactions decide which visuals respond to slicers.
- Four types of slicers: Regular, Button, Text, and List.
- Table visual is used for detailed row-wise data.
- Matrix visual provides grouped and summarized views.
- Conditional formatting strengthens insights.
- Power BI offers extensive customization to enhance the dashboard experience.

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